PROJECT PLANNING PHASE:

1. Project Scope & Deliverables

Define exactly what will be handed over at the end of the project.

- **Deliverable 1:** Custom Tables (`u_book`, `u_borrow_request`).
- **Deliverable 2:** Service Portal Page for book discovery and requesting.
- **Deliverable 3:** Flow Designer Automation (Borrowing, Approvals, and Overdue logic).
- **Deliverable 4:** Librarian Dashboard (Reporting on book circulation).

2. Resource Allocation

Who is doing the work?

- **ServiceNow Developer:** Builds the tables, flows, and portal widgets.
- **Business Analyst (BA):** Refines the approval rules with the Library staff.
- **QA/Tester:** Validates that the flow doesn't break when a record is missing (fixing the error in your screenshot!).
- **Product Owner:** The Head Librarian who signs off on the final design.

3. Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

Break the project into manageable "Epics" and "Stories."

- **Epic 1: Data Foundation**
  - *Story:* Create `u_book` table with ISBN, Title, and Status.
  - *Story:* Import initial book list via Data Load/Transform Map.
- **Epic 2: Automation & Logic**
  - *Story:* Build "Ask for Approval" flow for Librarians.
  - *Story:* Create "Overdue" scheduled job to trigger notifications.
- **Epic 3: User Experience**
  - *Story:* Design "Request a Book" Catalog Item in the Service Portal.

4. Timeline & Milestones (Gantt Chart View)

A typical 4-week build for a Smart Library system might look like this:

Week	Phase	Key Milestone
Week 1	**Development**	Tables and basic Form views completed.

Week	Phase	Key Milestone
Week 2	**Logic & Integration**	Flows (Ask for Approval) and Notifications active.
Week 3	**Testing (UAT)**	Librarians test the flow in the "Sub-Production" instance.
Week 4	**Deployment**	Push Update Sets to "Production" and Go-Live.

5. Risk Management Plan

Identify what could go wrong and how to fix it.

- **Risk:** Librarian is on leave and cannot approve requests.
  - *Mitigation:* Set up **Delegated Approvals** in ServiceNow so another staff member can step in.
- **Risk:** Data entry errors (e.g., missing mandatory fields).
  - *Mitigation:* Use **UI Policies** and **Data Policies** to make fields like "Book Record" mandatory before the flow even starts.

6. Communication Plan

How will the team stay in sync?

- **Daily Stand-ups:** 15-minute sync to discuss blockers (like the mandatory field error you encountered).
- **Sprint Demo:** Weekly walkthrough of the working flow for the stakeholders.
- **Documentation:** Maintain a "Technical Design Document" (TDD) inside the project's Knowledge Base.